

### festival

## Classic Touch

**DELHI** Dance is the language of gods. In India, there are innumerable dance forms—both classical and folk—which constitute a part of daily lives. A five-day festival, *Ananya: The Unparalleled—A Dialogue of Indian Classical Dance with Heritage Monument*, begins on October 11 to celebrate the beauty of Indian classical dance. Its focus will be on group choreography. Considering the youth's lack of interest in such dance forms, the organisers have chosen Purana Qila as the festival's venue to attract them.

A Bharatnatyam performance by Kalakshetra dancers from Chennai, choreographed by Leela Samson, will be the first presentation. It will begin with a keerthanam on Lord Shiva's Ananda Tandava, followed by Kalinga Nartanam depicting Lord Krishna's victory over the cobra king Kalinga. It will be followed by a dance theatre narrative of *The Three Musketeers*. The

finale of the day would be a medley of three tillanas.

On October 12, Jayaprabha Menon and her troupe will perform *Layalahiri*—a combination of Kathakali (a representation of tandava) and Mohiniattam. The next day, Guru Durga Charan Ranbir's troupe will set the stage on fire with an Odissi performance. They will start with Siba Mangalacharan followed by Sthayee and Aditya Archana. October 14 will see Jai Kishore Mosalikanti and his group's Kuchipudi performance. The finale of the festival will be presented by Malti Shyam's group. Belonging to the Lucknow Gharana, Shyam—Pandit Birju Maharaj's protégée—will present the dance form which is best known for its intricate footwork: Kathak.

If you are a dance buff, you can even participate in a two-day seminar, Pratibimb, on October 13 and 14 at Alliance Francaise de Delhi. The eminent panel of speakers includes Samson, Menon, Ranbir, Mosalikanti and Shyam.

by S. Sahaya Ranjit

### art exhibition

## Threads of Heritage

**MUMBAI** Whether it is traditional dance forms like garba or changing fashion trends, traditional forms have a habit of being reincarnated time and again, only to be presented in new avatars. Shelly Jyoti's *Beyond Mithila—Exploring the Decorative* is a collection of paintings and textile embroideries that tries to achieve the same effect. She explores the decorative elements of Madhubani art and translates them into a modern idiom. Her canvases and embroidery portray a spiritual experience of art that belongs to the 7th century in the 21st. Not only does she borrow from Mithila paintings, Jyoti also takes inspiration from diverse decorative traditions of India and beyond. She has resurrected Indian threadworks like kantha from Bengal to international influences like Persian zardozi and different Chinese embroideries. Jyoti has forged them with her own brand of heterogeneous and ornamental paintings. The month-long exhibition begins from October 3. by Swati Mathur

### DECORATIVE DELIGHTS: Works on display



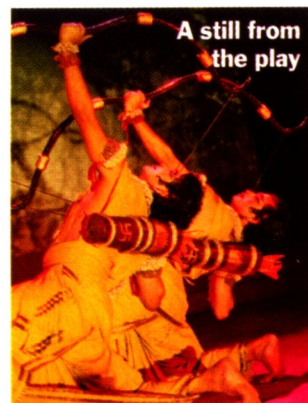
### RIGHT MOVES: A Bharatnatyam performance by Kalakshetra



### theatre

## Divine Intervention

**DELHI** Lord Ram's story has been depicted as a simple "triumph of good over evil". His life consists of a multitude of episodes, from which his divinity and compassion come forth. Whether it is Ahilya Uddhar or Shabri Moksha, there is not a single episode that has a blemish. Relive them at the Shriram Bharatiya Kala Kendra's



production *Ram*, directed by Shubha Deepak Singh. At Kamani Auditorium. On till October 26.